Tam Nguyen

Research Operations & Program Management

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SUMMARY

Research operations specialist who builds the panels, tools, and guardrails that make research fast, high quality, and ethical. 5+ years across research and research ops, most recently supporting ~150 studies a year for a 35-person research team across core banking, bitcoin, buy now, pay later, and B2B at Block. MS in Psychology.

EXPERIENCE

Research Operations Specialist | Block (Square, Cash App, Afterpay, Bitkey) | 10/2022 - 02/2026

- Cut recruitment time **50%** by building a 25,000+ person research panel from scratch, including a large group of parents and teens, and taking over customer list pulls from data science.
- Reduced interview no-shows from **3-4 to 0-2 per 12** for sessions watched live by ~15 teammates, by recruiting backups and automating reminders and NDAs for a year-long rolling program and in-person panels.
- Shifted **about a third of ~150 yearly studies** to self-serve (15 of 35 researchers) by writing playbooks and QA checklists, coaching 10 researchers 1-1, and rolling out Rally.
- Kept thrown-out paid responses to **2-5%** (from 10-15% on loose lists), saving **~$500-1,000 per survey**, and cut drop-off from **20% to 15%** through SQL targeting, screener standards, and AI-assisted review.
- Sped up vendor onboarding **25%** with no compliance issues by setting PII, consent, and retention rules with Legal, and ran privacy-safe survey ops for Block's published Modern Earner research.
- Cut research tool spend **15%+** on a six-figure budget by recommending consolidation around Rally, Qualtrics, Maze, and Dovetail; managed 10+ vendor contracts and cut incentive payouts from hours to minutes.

Field Research Evaluator (Contract) | Google (Waymo) | 07/2026 - Present

- Rate unreleased self-driving software in **4-6 hour rides** for driving quality and rider comfort.
- Write rationales and bug reports that **helped engineering fix launch blockers**.

Graduate Research Assistant (PhD program, Psychology) | University of Wisconsin-Madison | 08/2020 - 05/2022

- **Designed and ran 10+ studies with 500+ people** on assistive AR and VR learning.
- Ran qualitative and quantitative analysis (Python, R) and **trained 3 researchers** to score consistently.
- Managed IRB and privacy for **two labs (VR and AR) with 100% approval** and a **$75K grant**.

SKILLS

Research ops: participant recruitment, panel and sample management, self-serve enablement, vendors and budget, privacy and governance

Methods: surveys, interviews, unmoderated tests, thematic analysis, statistics

Tools: Rally, Qualtrics, Dovetail, Maze, dscout, UserTesting, Airtable, Jira, SQL, Python, R, Claude, Gemini

EDUCATION

MS Psychology, University of Wisconsin-Madison

BS Psychology, Minor in Computer Science, University of Louisiana at Monroe